BGIN Block #9 Meeting Report

- Rebuilding Value, Governance and Reputation on Blockchain -

blockchain
governance
initiative
network

The Global Network for Blockchain Stakeholders™

© 2023 BGIN (Blockchain Governance Initiative Network) is registered as BN Association, a Japanese general association with its principal place of business at Shiba Building, 704, 4-7-6, Shiba, Minato-ku, Tokyo. All rights reserved.

The know-how described in this document was made available from contributions from various sources, including members of the BGIN and others. Although the BGIN has taken steps to help ensure that the know how is available for distribution, it takes no position regarding the validity or scope of any intellectual property or other rights that might be claimed to pertain to the implementation or use of the know how described in this document or the extent to which any license under such rights might or might not be available; neither does it represent that it has made any independent effort to identify any such rights. BGIN and the contributors to this document make no (and hereby expressly disclaim any) warranties (express, implied, or otherwise), including implied warranties of merchantability, non-infringement, fitness for a particular purpose, or title, related to this document, and the entire risk as to implementing this document is assumed by the implementer. The BGIN Intellectual Property Rights policy requires contributors to offer a patent promise not to assert certain patent claims against other contributors and against implementers. BGIN invites any interested party to bring to its attention any copyrights, patents, patent applications, or other proprietary rights that may cover technology that may be required to practice this document.

3.16. IKPWG Interactive Workshop Session 3: Digital Identity - a global discourse

Date: Nov 21, 2023
Time: 15:30 - 17:00
Session Chair: Nat Sakimura (OpenID)

Discussion points

- The definition of 'privacy' is ambiguous. Interpretation of the term varies among people. There are many kinds of privacy - data privacy, social privacy, etc.

- The vast amount of data that is being collected about you does not really matter. Information selling to you, customizing the news feed to you, and targeting propaganda towards you, might have a much bigger impact on your life than what everyone is worried about - a honeypot data. Data privacy can be taken from you without knowing and you can be a given target, being manipulated.

- Defining privacy is not productive. Adherence to privacy principles is the best approach for privacy. For example, the OECD privacy principles are a mandate to governments, and when it is applied to industry, you need to add something extra.

- What are key policy considerations surrounding digital identity on a global scale? How can they be harmonized to facilitate cross boarder interactions?

    - In the case of doing an identification, the outcome is different in every single case, since we need to know different things about different people. One of the missteps in our field was that the concept of digital identity is a very fluid and abstract concept - being any claim about a different subject.

    - The practice should be to really focus on the treatment of data problem. It is useful to boil down digital identity as data of a set of attributes. What do you need to know about somebody to do an identification? How are you going to know that? The best practice might be metadata. What we need is the subject in front of us and we need to be able to think about the metadata that tells us whether the subject is true or viable.

    - Your credit card number is never transmitted, and what is transmitted is a token that works only once. If regulation catches up, we should have AML things that should never know name, address, date of birth, citizenship, but basically just get a flag that says it is fine. Now there's a lot that needs to happen for that to work because someone needs to know such information. We need to have a process that is as secure as the one that we have today, while still creating data minimization. Theoretically, it is good enough that you have six merchants and they all have different tokens. And the postal organization knows how to translate those tokens back into your info since if there is a data leak at the merchant, it just gets gibberish. (The most useful information for the AML process is physically where one exists in the world. If the bank not only does not have info on your PII and address, but also does not understand risk profile of you, your activities, and all of your other attributes and characteristics, how can the bank risk profile you being a customer? How can they understand you?)

- Data Minimization: What information do you need? Which should you acquire information itself or token? Data minimization is the limitation or processing of collected data, and such collected data should not be processed without tokenized.

- What would be the effective ways for multi-stakeholders to have this discourse continuously?

    - The efforts by the BGIN, the Open ID foundation and the Open Wallet Foundation can bring people together on all of the three levels including regulations, specifications, and code.